

quality of the noun, which is in accord with the context. Joining context to ‘batting average’, or credibility quotient, I stick with **f**³⁵ here.

του 4:2 [22%]

Most of the fourteen non-**f**³⁵ MSS listed by *ECM* for this variant are shared with δυνάμενος in James 3:2. The fourteen will reduce to eight independent lines of transmission in the 5th century, or so I imagine, some of which will go back to the 3rd. The choice between the presence or absence of the article here makes little difference in the sense, so because of its credibility quotient I stick with **f**³⁵.

και 2:21 P⁷² [23%]

This variant also is attested by fourteen non-**f**³⁵ MSS (listed by *ECM*), but only four are shared. There is more diversity this time, with only two pairs, so in the 5th century we still have twelve lines, most of which will go back to the 3rd, as I imagine. P⁷² gives overt 3rd century attestation. The reading of the majority is perfectly normal and makes excellent sense, so if it were original there would be no felt need to change it. On the other hand, the και next to the γαρ could easily appear to be unnecessary, motivating copyists to delete it. In the context the emphatic use fits nicely. This reading is certainly early and independent, and in my opinion most probably original.

περιερχεται 5:8 [24%]

The twenty-one non-**f**³⁵ MSS listed by *ECM* for this variant include all but one of those listed for του above, plus eight different ones. There are several groups, but there would be at least ten independent lines in the 5th century, at least half of which should go back to the 3rd, as I imagine. The lion is not out for an afternoon stroll, he is circling the prey, looking for an opening. Περιερχεται is early, independent and correct, and in my opinion almost certainly original.

ημερας ιδειν 3:10 C [26%]

The twenty-six non-**f**³⁵ MSS listed by *ECM* for this variant form several groups, but there would be at least fifteen independent lines in the 5th century—codex C gives overt 5th century attestation—at least half of which should go back to the 3rd, as I imagine. Since this is part of a quote from the Psalms, the LXX could be a factor, but how? Codex B has the same word order in its LXX of Psalms and here in Peter, while codex C agrees with the printed LXX. So who assimilated to whom? The word order attested by **f**³⁵ seems less smooth than that of the majority and may